

India's AI Vision Gains Momentum in Gujarat's GIFT City

India is rapidly advancing toward becoming a global hub for applied AI and deep-tech innovation. Riding this wave of transformation, Gujarat is stepping up as a frontrunner by embedding AI technology into its core governance and industry frameworks.

At the heart of this ambition lies the AI Centre of Excellence (AI CoE) established at GIFT City, an initiative by the Department of Science and Technology and Gujarat Informatics Limited, supported by the Ministry of Electronics & IT, in collaboration with Nasscom and Microsoft that was inaugurated by Hon'ble Chief Minister, Shri Bhupendra Patel. The Centre is envisioned to focus on accelerating AI adoption in SMEs, industries, and public services.

The AI CoE brings together deep-tech startups, industry leaders, policymakers, investors, and academia to build and scale digital solutions for real-world challenges. It is not just about promoting innovation; it is about solving problems that impact citizens and enterprises. The Centre is actively facilitating AI-driven solutions across key sectors, including automation in manufacturing, diagnostics in healthcare, and improved service delivery in public administration.

The [AI Innovation Challenge](#), a flagship initiative, connects India's AI and deep-tech startups with real-world challenges from government bodies and industries. By inviting solutions to specific problems in sectors like public services, manufacturing, healthcare, and more, the challenge fosters scalable innovation and accelerates AI adoption across domains. Launched by the Hon'ble Chief Minister of Gujarat, the challenge attracted 18 use cases from manufacturers, healthcare organizations, MSMEs, and government entities, receiving 227 applications from over 90 startups.

A recent example of its impact is a bilingual AI-powered chatbot solution that was recently developed for a government portal by a startup accelerated by the AI CoE. This chatbot provides information in both English and Gujarati, through both voice and text, demonstrating how AI can be leveraged to make government services more accessible and user-friendly.

The [GrowX](#) acceleration program by AI CoE is another major driver of innovation. It enables startups to co-create AI-powered solutions by offering access to advanced computing infrastructure, mentorship, funding support, and GTM support. Through the development of various Proofs of Concept (PoCs), the AI CoE is actively working towards enhancing industrial efficiency and improving the delivery of public services.

Another key highlight is the immersive AI Experience Zone, a futuristic space offering hands-on exposure to practical AI applications. The zone features live demonstrations of impactful AI solutions in manufacturing, healthcare, agriculture, and immersive technologies. These innovations offer visitors a clear view of how AI is driving transformation across sectors and improving operational efficiency on the ground.

With a clear roadmap ahead, the Centre is set to enable over 100 pilot projects and engage more than 3,000 stakeholders over the next five years. These efforts will further cement its position as a driving force in India's AI transformation.

Commenting on the vision behind the initiative, Sanjeev Malhotra, CEO of Nasscom CoE – IoT & AI, shares, "Our goal is not just to develop technology but to apply it practically across industries. By bringing together startups, policymakers, and industry, we are working toward making India a global leader in applied AI and deep-tech."

By aligning with the IndiaAI mission and empowering Gujarat's ecosystem, the AI CoE is poised to play a pivotal role in making AI inclusive, impactful, and scalable—not just for the state, but for the entire nation.

AI CoE – Gujarati Publication – Outline

Title – with keywords like 'AI' + 'Gujarat'

Introduction – India in AI, Gujarat's initiative in AI-inauguration of AI CoE, aim of AI CoE

Key initiatives - Launch of AI-IC, opportunity for startups for real-world adoption of smart solutions

Success story – bilingual chatbot on government website – **What** the startup did and **how** it is helping.

More initiatives - one-of-its-kind AI Experience Zone, nos. and types of startups displayed to experience, visits from various stakeholders in the ecosystem.

Quote by Sanjeev

KPI numbers – 15+ use-cases deployed, 60+ industries were connected, 2 Cr.+ funds raised by incubated startups in the past 3 months

GrowX - A hub for startups to exchange ideas, network and work together

Training Workshops for govt. officials and Industry leaders.

Plan for the next 5 years and conclusion – over the next 5 years, we aim to facilitate 100+ pilot projects and engage 3,000+ stakeholders.